

RESPONDING TO STUDENTS ENGAGED IN BULLYING BEHAVIOURS

Response Continuum

	Tier 1 — Universal prevention and early response	Tier 2 — Targeted support and intervention	Tier 3 — Intensive, individualised and coordinated response
1. Safety, reporting and immediate response	☐ Accessible, age-appropriate reporting pathways ☐ Clear staff response procedures and responsibilities ☐ Prompt acknowledgement of reports ☐ Immediate assessment of safety and ongoing risk ☐ Active supervision in identified locations ☐ Clear expectations and proportionate consequences ☐ Protection from retaliation ☐ Regular review of incident and location data (i.e. PBL/SORD))	☐ Individual reporting system/process or nominated contact (authorized environment) ☐ Scheduled follow-up with affected students ☐ Individual safety and support plan (ISP/IBSP) where required ☐ Targeted monitoring of classes, breaks, transport and transitions (and online interactions if required) ☐ Identified safe locations and staff contacts ☐ Arrival, departure and transition check-ins ☐ Communication plan across relevant staff (i.e. “at a glance or email thread) ☐ Pattern analysis of frequency, location, peers, triggers and impact AND Short-cycle review of whether harm has stopped ☐ Short-term or mid-term case meeting to align responses where required	☐ Comprehensive risk and safety plan (ISP/IBSP) ☐ Immediate senior leadership oversight and case management ☐ Supervised arrival, departure, movement and transitions (separations where safety is concerned) ☐ Timetable, class, transport or playground-zone changes (separations where safety is concerned) ☐ Police, Child Safety or emergency engagement where thresholds are met ☐ Formal multi-agency safety planning ☐ Planned reintegration after suspension
2. Positive school culture, belonging and protective experiences	☐ Intentionally build Positive and Benevolent Childhood Experiences ☐ Every student connected to at least one trusted adult ☐ Explicit norms for inclusion, safety and respect ☐ Consistent welcome, recognition and positive feedback routines ☐ Student voice and participation ☐ Inclusive clubs, teams, cultural groups and lunchtime activities (appropriate to school context) ☐ Strengths-based opportunities for success and contribution ☐ Whole-school belonging and engagement strategies ☐ Culturally responsive practice and visible representation	☐ Daily or scheduled Check In/Check Out (regular wellbeing conversations) ☐ Trusted adult, mentor or year-level contact ☐ Supported entry into a club, team or structured activity ☐ Intentional positive contact with home ☐ Individual belonging and engagement goals ☐ Planned opportunities for safe peer success ☐ Targeted cultural, identity or community connection	☐ Intensive case management ☐ Wraparound planning with family and agencies ☐ Re-engagement plan following disengagement or suspension ☐ Intensive cultural or community liaison support ☐ Alternative or flexible engagement options – I.e. Supported Play, Intervention, 1:1 Learning Support, etc. ☐ Brokerage for therapeutic programs
3. Explicit teaching and social-emotional skill development	☐ Explicit teaching of respectful relationships – RRE Program ☐ Clear teaching about bullying, conflict, teasing and aggression – Whole school, cohort, class ☐ Social Emotional Learning programs (School designed or purchased such as Berry Street, The Resilience Project, You can do it!, Smiling Mind, Wellio, etc.) ☐ Digital citizenship and safe online conduct – Integrated into Dig Technology/Dig Lit programs	☐ Individual or small-group teaching of identified skill gaps (SEL groups) ☐ Teaching repair, apology and restitution – Restorative Practice ☐ Emotional regulation and impulse-control instruction (ZoR) ☐ Pre-correction before predictable high-risk situations – Connected to Check in processes ☐ Conflict-resolution and problem-solving skill programs (i.e. Rock and Water, RAGE)	☐ Intensive individual skills program informed by assessment ☐ Individual curriculum addressing harmful relational or coercive behaviour ☐ Repeated practice across settings with adult coaching ☐ Functional communication and replacement-skill teaching ☐ Therapeutic intervention for complex mental health or trauma needs ☐ Specialist sexual behaviour support where relevant ☐ Intensive digital-safety planning and education ☐ General planning across home, school and community – Case meeting cycles
4. Environment, supervision and opportunity reduction	☐ Active and visible staff supervision ☐ Mapping of bullying hotspots and vulnerable times (SORD Behaviour Dashboard or PBL) ☐ Predictable classroom and playground routines ☐ Clear physical and digital behaviour expectations ☐ Thoughtful seating, grouping and transitions ☐ Staff presence during arrival, departure and movement ☐ Safe use of toilets, change rooms and shared spaces ☐ Structured options during breaks	☐ Individual seating and grouping plan ☐ Structured lunch break plan ☐ Supported transitions between classes or locations ☐ Staggered movement or adjusted access ☐ Increased supervision during identified high-risk times ☐ Planned access to a regulation or reset space ☐ Temporary adjustment to devices, platforms or group chats ☐ Reduced unstructured contact	☐ Class, subject, timetable, transport or playground changes ☐ Individual escort or direct handover arrangements ☐ Highly structured learning and break schedule (individual timetable) ☐ Intensive adult supervision plan ☐ Restricted contact arrangements consistent with policy and rights ☐ Environmental assessment by specialist personnel ☐ Formal review before reducing protective arrangements

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5. Individual behaviour assessment, planning and accountability	☐ Consistent implementation of the Student Code of Conduct ☐ Clear and consistent consequences and rewards ☐ Classroom rules and expectations ☐ Consistent documentation (OneSchool) ☐ Staff calibration about minor, major and bullying behaviours	☐ Individual behaviour goals and progress monitoring ☐ Behaviour support or targeted support plan (IBSP) ☐ Functional behavior assessment (FBA) ☐ Analysis of ABC data ☐ Escalation mapping (behaviour escalation map) ☐ Check In/Check Out linked to expectations - Explicit discussion of behaviour, impact, consequence and future choices	☐ Individual Behaviour Support Plan developed by a multidisciplinary team (IBSP) ☐ Formal case manager and scheduled reviews (Complex Case Management) ☐ Specialist behaviour, inclusion or disability consultation (external) ☐ Post-suspension re-entry plan
6. Disability adjustments	☐ Differentiated and engaging teaching and learning ☐ Reasonable adjustments based on functional need ☐ Universal Design for Learning ☐ Explicit instruction and clear success criteria ☐ Predictable routines and manageable task demands ☐ Communication supports and visual prompts	☐ Individual task, seating, grouping and work arrangements ☐ Reduce cognitive or sensory overload during high-risk periods ☐ Communication scripts, visual supports and social narratives ☐ Supported peer interaction and structured group roles ☐ Targeted literacy, learning or executive-function intervention ☐ Planned movement, sensory or regulation breaks ☐ Individualised engagement and success goals ☐ Consult HOSSES, inclusion staff or specialist teachers	☐ Review of disability adjustments and access – Documented in PLR and support provisions ☐ Specialist assessment of communication, sensory, executive-function or learning needs ☐ Autism and other specialist advisory support ☐ Individualised timetable, curriculum or environment ☐ Coordinated NDIS-provider consultation within boundaries ☐ Review verification, resourcing or specialist support needs ☐ Regional inclusion or complex-case support
7. Wellbeing, mental health and student support services	☐ Whole-school wellbeing program ☐ Access to school wellbeing staff ☐ Processes for the identification of anxiety, trauma, grief, identity or peer concerns ☐ Clear referral pathways	☐ Guidance Officer consultation or referral ☐ School-based youth health, wellbeing or chaplaincy support Individual emotional regulation or coping plan (recorded as a support provision) ☐ Targeted counselling (i.e. School-based Psychologist or GO referral) ☐ Frequent positive wellbeing checks ☐ Referral to GP or community health ☐ Collaborative planning with treating professionals, with consent	☐ Immediate wellbeing or mental health assessment where risk is elevated (Engage with GP) ☐ Suicide/self-harm procedures (Safety planning) ☐ CYMHS, Headspace, paediatric, psychological or psychiatric engagement ☐ Coordinated school–health case planning (linking in school health personal) ☐ Substance-use or youth-justice support where relevant
8. Family partnership and capability building	☐ Positive contact not limited to incidents ☐ Clear explanation of expectations and processes ☐ Clear reporting and complaint pathways ☐ Shared language around bullying and conflict ☐ Sharing ParentLine with school community	☐ Scheduled contact and progress updates ☐ Shared goals and consistent language across home and school ☐ Parent-line referral ☐ Support access to GP, allied health or community services	☐ Dedicated school contact or case manager ☐ Family and Child Connect or Intensive Family Support referral ☐ Child Safety engagement ☐ Cultural liaison, interpreter or community representative involvement ☐ Brokerage for identified needs ☐ Support for attendance, transport, housing or crisis factors
10. Cultural safety, identity and inclusion	☐ Culturally responsive curriculum and practices ☐ Accessible participation for students with disability ☐ First Nations perspectives and community partnerships ☐ Staff capability in bias and discrimination (where required) ☐ Clear response to identity-based bullying and harassment ☐ Safe mechanisms to raise cultural or identity concerns	☐ Engage First Nations staff, liaison staff or community representatives ☐ Targeted teaching addressing prejudice or discriminatory language	☐ Regional First Nations, inclusion, multicultural or specialist advisory support ☐ Intensive cultural safety planning ☐ Community-led or culturally informed intervention ☐ Multi-agency response to serious discrimination or exploitation ☐ Intensive staff capability development
11. Leadership, systems, documentation and review	☐ Clear schoolwide definition and response process ☐ Staff professional learning and role clarity ☐ Consistent OneSchool recording ☐ Data review by behaviour, location, time, cohort and group (SORD or PBL) ☐ Alignment with Student Code of Conduct ☐ Confidential communication protocols (anonymous reporting system) ☐ Leadership oversight of serious or repeated incidents	☐ Baseline measures and measurable goals ☐ Fidelity checks: were supports implemented? Has frequency, severity and impact reduced? (Line of sight)	☐ Formal multidisciplinary case management ☐ Complex case review with assigned actions ☐ Brokerage referrals where appropriate ☐ Cross-agency information sharing consistent with legislation